WEEK 05 • IS321 ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTURE

The EA Repository

Where Enterprise Architecture Documentation Comes to Life

TODAY'S ROADMAP

What We'll Cover

01	What Is the EA Repository?	The online archive that makes EA documentation usable, not just written down
02	The Repository Structure	Six columns × three levels of view — the actual textbook figure
03	Reading the Three Views	High Level, Mid Level, and Detailed View — the same column at different depths
04	The Sixth Column: Security Solutions	Why the repository adds a column beyond Week 3's five levels
05	Worked Example	Drilling into one column across all three views
06	Why the Repository Matters	Accessibility, consistency, and stakeholder communication

What Is the EA Repository?

centralized storage hub - either in the form of a website / DB

> *An online archive — essentially a website and database — that stores EA documentation and links to EA tools and program resources, so every stakeholder can access the same information.*
>
> — The role of the EA Repository (Bernard, 2012)

serves as a single source of truth

Why it matters

Makes the Plan Usable

Week 4's EA Management Plan describes what should happen; the repository is where the actual artifacts live.

One Source for Every Stakeholder

Executives, business owners, and engineers all pull from the same place — no conflicting versions.

Organized, Not Just Stored

Information is structured by column and by level of detail, so anyone can find what they need quickly.

↳ structured through different levels of abstractions to facilitate

Six Columns, Three Levels of View

EA Management Plan	Future EA Views	EA Standards	EA Program	EA Tutorial	Site Map

Enterprise Architecture Repository

Current EA Views	Goals & Initiatives	Products & Services	Data & Information	Systems & Applications	Networks & Infrastructure	Security Solutions
High Level View	Strategic Plan	Business Plan	Knowledge Warehouse	Business Systems	Wide Area Network	Security Program
Mid Level View	Goals & Initiatives	Business Processes	Information Flows	Support Systems	Local Area Network	System Certifications
Detailed View	Performance Measures	Investment Portfolio	Data Dictionary	Application Inventory	Buildings & Equipment	Data Privacy

— *Bernard (2012), An Introduction to Enterprise Architecture*

Reading the Grid

Columns are the six areas of the enterprise. Rows are how deep you're looking — from a boardroom summary down to individual artifacts.

each row determines the scope of the documentation, tailored to specific business audience

THE NEW IDEA THIS WEEK

Three Levels of View

Week 3 introduced the five levels as columns. The repository adds a second dimension — how much detail you're looking at within any column.



High Level View

A boardroom summary — one line per column. Enough for an executive to see the whole enterprise at a glance.

↓ gain a holistic insight

Example: "Strategic Plan" under Goals & Initiatives.



Mid Level View

One step down — the working detail a program manager or architect needs day to day.

pertains to day-to-day operations

Example: "Goals & Initiatives" document itself, or "Business Processes."



Detailed View

The individual artifacts — specific documents, diagrams, and data an analyst would actually open.

Example: "Performance Measures" or "Data Dictionary."

NEW CONTENT — NOT COVERED IN WEEK 3

The Sixth Column: Security Solutions



Why a sixth column?

Week 3 covered five levels: Goals & Initiatives through Networks & Infrastructure. The repository adds a sixth column — Security Solutions — because security needs its own dedicated documentation, even though it also runs as a thread through the other five.

EXAMPLE

High Level: "Security Program." Mid Level: "System Certifications." Detailed: "Data Privacy" records — the same three-view structure as every other column.

What lives in this column

- The enterprise's security program documentation
- System and component certifications
- Data privacy records and controls
- Cross-reference to the Threads element (Week 6)

WORKED EXAMPLE

Drilling Into “Data & Information”

Week 3's worked example moved horizontally across columns. This one moves vertically — down through the three views within a single column.

	**High Level View**	Knowledge Warehouse	A single-line summary an executive skims in a board deck.
	**Mid Level View**	Information Flows	The working diagram an architect references when planning integration.
	**Detailed View**	Data Dictionary	The actual field-by-field definitions an analyst opens to resolve a question.

BRINGING IT TOGETHER

Why the Repository Matters

Stakeholder Communication

Every audience — executive, manager, engineer — finds the depth of detail that fits their role, without a separate document for each.

Keeps the Management Plan Current

As Week 4's Management Plan is updated, the repository is where those updates actually get stored and made accessible.

Consistency Across the Enterprise

The same six-column, three-view structure applies everywhere — no department invents its own format.

A Single Source of Truth

One place to look, instead of scattered spreadsheets, slide decks, and inboxes holding different versions of the truth.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Key Takeaways

- The EA Repository is the online archive that makes EA documentation actually usable — an organized website and database, not just a folder of files.
- It's structured as a grid: six columns (the five levels from Week 3, plus Security Solutions) by three levels of view (High, Mid, Detailed).
- The same information exists at every level of detail — stakeholders just choose how deep to look.
- Security Solutions gets its own column because it needs dedicated documentation, even though it also runs as a thread through every other column.
- The repository is where Week 4's EA Management Plan gets put into practice — it's the living archive behind the living document.

COMING UP NEXT

Further Reading & Next Session

Reading Material

- Bernard, S. (2012). An Introduction to Enterprise Architecture (3rd ed.) — Primary text
- PSU IS321 Syllabus — Week 3 (EA Core Components) and Week 4 (EA Management Program)
- The Open Group — TOGAF Standard, Version 9.2 (Architecture Repository concept)

Next: Week 6

EA Value and Risk

Questions?